

C07 ENHANCED HEALTH AND WELL-BEING PROMOTION | O (MAX : 2 PT)

Intent : Cultivate a culture that prioritizes and promotes the health and well-being of all individuals.

Summary : This WELL feature requires projects to cultivate a culture of health through communications, health promotion programs and executive-level leadership.

Issue : Workplaces have the potential to promote and encourage healthy behaviors; however, if employees are unaware of the health promotion opportunities available, they are unlikely to participate.^{1,2} Moreover, studies of organizations with successful workplace wellness programs demonstrate that isolated incentives or programs, or even just health-promoting physical environments alone, will not be effective in promoting employee health or engaging employees in healthy behaviors unless they are part of an overarching culture of health integrated into everyday operations.³

Solutions : The Robert Wood Johnson Foundation defines a culture of health as "a society that gives all individuals an equal opportunity to live the healthiest lives possible, whatever their ethnic, geographic, racial, socioeconomic or physical circumstances happen to be."³ Organizations can build a culture of health through customized health promotion programs that are integrated into operations and business strategy, promoted through consistent communications, championed by leadership at all levels and given dedicated resources.^{4,5} Incorporating incentives can raise employee participation and motivate behavior change such as weight loss and smoking cessation.⁶ Medical and absenteeism costs fall by about \$3.27 and \$2.73, respectively, for every dollar spent on workplace health programs.⁶ Successful health promotion programs can improve job satisfaction, sense of well-being, self-esteem and health status, and reduce stress and health risks.^{7,8} Organizational benefits include lower healthcare costs and absenteeism and improved productivity, recruitment, retention, culture and employee morale.^{7,8}

PART 1 PROMOTE CULTURE OF HEALTH (MAX : 1 PT)

For All Spaces:

1: Health promotion strategies

Occupant health and well-being is promoted through the following:

- a. Monthly digital communications to employees and/or regular occupants (as applicable) that address the following:
 1. Reinforce the project's culture of health.
 2. Market health promotion policies and programs.
 3. Highlight stories from regular occupants (as applicable) who exemplify the project's health culture.
 4. Offer education (e.g., tips and resources created by the project or a third party) on at least two topics within the ten WELL concepts.⁹
- b. Quarterly education sessions (e.g., workshops, lectures, seminars) that offer instruction on topics within the ten WELL concepts, covering at least two different concepts per year.

2: Health promotion coordinators

One of the following is present:

- a. Health promotion group that meets at least quarterly, is actively involved in planning and implementing health promotion programs and policies and seeks to cultivate a culture of health in the project.⁹
- b. Paid mid- or senior-level employee that plans and implements health promotion programs. Health promotion must be part of their job description, requirements and/or performance expectations.⁹ Projects that meet Part 2 Health Promotion Leader automatically fulfill this requirement.

PART 2 ESTABLISH HEALTH PROMOTION LEADER (MAX : 1 PT)

For All Spaces:

The following requirements are met:

- a. Project has at least one dedicated executive-level employee whose primary responsibility is to plan and oversee strategies that promote the physical, mental and emotional health and well-being of all employees (e.g., Chief Wellness Officer). The individual must be employed at the executive (C-Suite) level or report directly to a member of the executive (C-Suite) team.
- b. Executive-level employee's job description and performance expectations must include the following:
 1. Established metrics or KPIs for promoting organizational health and well-being that are linked to employee's performance evaluation.
 2. At minimum annual reports by the employee on the progress of health promotion strategies and employee engagement to the executive (C-suite) team, Board of Directors and/or equivalent high-level stakeholders.
- c. Executive-level employee is supported by at minimum one employee who helps plan and implement health promotion programs and policies.

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